

Heather Cho, the former Korean Air executive who ordered an international flight to return to the gate over how macadamia nuts were served in first class, has been sentenced to a year in jail.

A South Korean court on Thursday found her guilty of violating aviation law, changing flight path and interference of operations. The judge said that Cho was a passenger on the Korean Air flight and could not override crew members and give orders during a flight.

On December 5, Cho, the daughter of the airline chairman, ordered an international flight back to the gate at New York's JFK airport after becoming dissatisfied that her macadamia nuts were served in a bag instead of on a plate in first class.

She had the chief steward removed from the flight after the plane had departed from the gate. The judge criticized Cho's conduct, saying if she had a conscience, the incident would not have happened, and said the former executive had used the plane as if it was her own car.

He added that her actions threatened the development of the aviation industry and inconvenienced passengers. The flight arrived 11 minutes behind schedule.